

The Preamble

*The **objective resolution** was moved to the Constituent Assembly on **13th December 1946** by Pt. Jawahar Lal Nehru, and it was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on **22 January 1947**. Later, this Resolution became the foundation of the Preamble.

*The words '**Socialist**', '**Secular**' and '**Integrity**' were incorporated in the Preamble by the **42nd Constitutional Amendment Act 1976**.

*The Preamble declares India as a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic and Republic Nation. It secures to all its citizens, justice of three types – social, economic and political. It is very helpful in the legal interpretation of the Indian Constitution. *In the words of Sir Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar, "The Preamble to our Constitution expresses what we had thought or dreamt so long".

*The Supreme Court accepted it as a part of the Constitution in the **Keshavanand Bharti case(1973)**. *Before this, in the **Berubari case (1960)**, the Preamble was not considered a part of the Constitution. *In **Golaknath vs State of Punjab (1967)**, the preamble was considered as the core soul of the Constitution. *In **Bommai vs Union of India (1994)**, the Supreme Court again gave the concept that the Preamble is a part of the Constitution.

*It is **non – justiciable** in nature. *It talks about the freedom of faith, belief, worship, expression and thought. *It also ensures dignity and equal opportunities for all. *It is called as the **soul of the Constitution**.

*Dr. B. R. Ambedkar called the **right to Constitutional remedies (Art. 32) as the heart and soul of the Constitution**.

*K. M. Munshi called the Preamble the **political horoscope**.

*Subhash Kashyap said that, if the Constitution is the body then the preamble is the soul; if the Constitution is building then the preamble is the foundation stone.

*Dr. B.R. Ambedkar said that "the Constitution is a pious paper."

1. In the following quotation,

"WE THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a (Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, Republic) and to secure to all its citizens.

JUSTICE, social, economic and political;

LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith, and worship;

EQUALITY of status and of opportunity: and to promote among them all;

FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the Individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation.

In our Constituent Assembly, this 'X' do hereby adopt, enact and give to ourselves this Constitution.", 'X' stands for :

- (a) Twenty-sixth day of January, 1950
- (b) Twenty-sixth day of November, 1949
- (c) Twenty-sixth day of January, 1949
- (d) None of the above

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The Indian Constitution starts with the preamble, which outlines the main objectives of the Constitution. The Preamble describes the nature, objectives, and ideals of the Indian political system. It also contains the date on which the Constitution was adopted, i.e. 26 November, 1949. The term "X" stands for the adoption date. Thus, option (b) is the correct answer.

2. What was the exact Constitutional Status of the Indian Republic on 26-1-1950 when the Constitution came into force?

- (a) A Democratic Republic
- (b) A Sovereign Democratic Republic
- (c) A Sovereign Secular Democratic Republic
- (d) A Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

U.P. Lower (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The Constitution of India came into force on 26th January 1950. The exact Constitutional status on 26-1-1950 was 'A SOVEREIGN DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC.' The words socialist, secular and integrity were added by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976.

3. What was the exact constitutional status of India on 26th January, 1950?

- (a) A Democratic Republic
- (b) A Sovereign Democratic Republic
- (c) A Sovereign Secular Democratic Republic
- (d) A Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. The mind of the makers of the constitution of India is reflected in which of the following?

- (a) The Preamble
- (b) The Fundamental Rights
- (c) The Directive Principles of State Policy
- (d) The Fundamental Duties

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

The Preamble reflects the minds of the makers of the Constitution. K.M. Munshi called it the political horoscope.

5. The mind of the makers of the Constitution of India is reflected in which of the following?

- (a) The Preamble
- (b) The Fundamental Rights
- (c) The Directive Principles of the State Policy
- (d) The Fundamental Duties

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

The Preamble of a document is an introductory statement which clarifies the objectives and philosophy of the document. In Berubari Case 1960, the Supreme Court held that the preamble is the key to the minds of the Constitution makers. Pt. Thakur Das Bhargava said that the Preamble is the soul of the Constitution. The idea of the Preamble was adopted from the Constitution of the United States of America.

6. How many types of justice, liberty, equality and fraternity in that order have been mentioned in the preamble of constitution of India?

- (a) 3, 5, 2, 1
- (b) 1, 3, 5, 2
- (c) 2, 5, 3, 1
- (d) 5, 2, 1, 3

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The Preamble of the Constitution mentions 3 types of justice, 5 types of liberty, 2 types of equality and one Kind of fraternity.

7. In the context of the Preamble of Indian Constitution which of the following sequence is correct?

- (a) Republic, People's, Democratic, Secular, Socialist, Universal, Sovereign
- (b) Sovereign, Socialist, Democratic, People's, Secular, Republic
- (c) Sovereign, Socialist, People's, Democratic, Secular, Socialist Republic
- (d) Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, Republic

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

The Preamble to the Indian Constitution, as amended by the 42nd Amendment in 1976 is - We the People of India, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic....” The word 'People's' is not mentioned in the Preamble of the Indian Constitution. This particular word has been mentioned in the Constitution of China. Thus option (d) is the correct answer.

8. Which among the following is the correct order mentioned in Preamble of the Indian Constitution?

- (a) Socialist, Secular, Sovereign, Democratic
- (b) Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic
- (c) Secular, Socialist, Sovereign, Democratic
- (d) Sovereign, Secular, Socialist, Democratic

UP R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

The preamble of the Indian Constitution- WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC and to secure to all its citizens : JUSTICE, social, economic and political; LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship; EQUALITY of status and of opportunity; and to promote among them all FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation; IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949, do HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION. Obviously, the correct order is- Sovereign, Socialist, Secular and Democratic.

9. In which form is India declared in the Preamble of Indian Constitution?

- (a) A Sovereign, Democratic, Republic
- (b) A Socialist, Democratic, Republic
- (c) A Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic
- (d) None of these

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Consider the following words.

- (A) Socialist
- (B) Democratic
- (C) Sovereign
- (D) Secular

Choose the correct sequence of words as given in the Preamble.

- (a) C, A, D and B (b) C, D, A and B
(c) C, D, B and A (d) D, A, C and B

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. The expression "Socialist" was introduced in the Preamble of Indian Constitution by which amendment?

- (a) 42nd amendment
(b) 44th amendment
(c) 46th amendment
(d) 74th amendment
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60-62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The preamble has been amended by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act (1976), which added three new words : socialist, secular and integrity.

12. Which of the following was inserted in the 'Preamble' of the Constitution of India, through 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act?

- (a) Sovereignty
(b) Dignity of person
(c) Socialist, secular
(d) Privacy

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

13. The words 'Secular' and 'Socialist' were added to the Preamble of the Indian Constitution by the

- (a) 39th Amendment (b) 41st Amendment
(c) 42nd Amendment (d) 44th Amendment

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

U.P. P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

14. Which two words have been incorporated in the Preamble by 42nd Amendment ?

- (a) Demgeratic and socialist
(b) Flapublic and secular

- (c) Socialist and sovgreign
(d) Secular and socialist

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (d)

Through the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1976, the words "Socialist," "Secular," and "Integrity" were added to the Preamble of the Indian Constitution. The 42nd Constitutional Amendment was based on the recommendations of the Swaran Singh Committee.

15. Which one of the following describes India as a Secular State?

- (a) Fundamental Rights
(b) Preamble to the Constitution
(c) 9th Schedule
(d) Directive Principles

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

The Preamble of the Constitution contains the word 'Secular' which was added to the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976. Thus, it declares India as a Secular State.

16. Which one of the following words was not included in the Preamble of the Indian Constitution in 1975?

- (a) Fraternity (b) Sovereign
(c) Equality (d) Integrity

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

The word "Integrity" was not in the Constitution at the time of its commencement. It was added in 1976 by the 42nd Amendment Act.

17. Which of the following words have been added to the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment?

- I. Socialist II. Gram Swarajya
III. Secular IV. Sovereign

Select the correct answer by using the code given below:

Code :

- (a) I, II, III (b) I and III
(c) I, II, IV (d) II, III, IV

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. Consider the following statements in regards to the Preamble of Constitution and select the correct one using the code given below -

1. The objectives Resolution by Jawaharlal Nehru finally became Preamble
2. It is non-Justiciable.
3. It can't be amended
4. Preamble cannot override the specific provision of the Constitution

Code :

- (a) Only 1 and 2 (b) Only 1,2 and 4
(c) Only 1,2 and 3 (d) Only 2,3 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

The Objectives Resolution moved by Jawaharlal Nehru on 13 December, 1946 was unanimously adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 22 January, 1947. Later, this Resolution became the foundation of the Preamble. The Supreme Court said in the Keshwanand Bharti case that the Preamble of the Constitution can be used to explain the ambiguous areas of the Constitution. Amendment of the Preamble is possible and by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment, the words socialist, secular and integrity were added to it. It is non-justiciable, i.e. its provisions can't be enforced in a court of Law. It cannot override the provisions of the Constitution. Thus, in the above statements, only 1, 2 and 4 are correct.

19. What is the legal nature of the Preamble of the Constitution?

- (a) It is enforceable
- (b) It is not enforceable
- (c) It may be enforced in special circumstances
- (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. The Preamble of the Constitution was amended by-

- (a) 17th Amendment (b) 24th Amendment
- (c) 42nd Amendment (d) 44th Amendment

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

In 1976, the Preamble to the Constitution was modified by the 42nd Amendment. The characterization of India as a 'Sovereign Democratic Republic' changed to a 'Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic.' The term 'Unity of the Nation' was changed to 'Unity and Integrity of the Nation.'

21. Which of the following words were not present in the preamble of the Indian Constitution adopted on November 26, 1949?

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| (1) Republic | (2) Reliable |
| (3) Socialist | (4) Non-religious |
| (a) (1), (2), (3) | (b) (2), (3), (4) |
| (c) (1), (2), (4) | (d) (3), (4) |

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

The Preamble to the Indian Constitution adopted on 26 November, 1949 included the words Sovereign, Democratic and Republic. Later, by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976 the preamble was added three new words- Socialist, Secular and Integrity.

The words 'Reliable' and 'Non-religious' were never a part of the preamble and till now, only the above mentioned three words are added. Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

22. The term 'Socialist' was added in the Preamble by the -

- (a) 42nd Amendment (b) 44th Amendment
- (c) 52nd Amendment (d) None of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

23. By which Constitutional Amendment was the term 'Socialist' included in the Preamble?

- (a) First Constitutional Amendment
- (b) Second Constitutional Amendment
- (c) Forty-second Constitutional Amendment
- (d) Forty-Fourth Constitutional Amendment

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. In the Preamble of Constitution adopted on 26 November, 1949, which word/words was/were not present-

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| 1. Socialist | 3. Secular |
| 2. Integrity | 4. Republic |

Choose the correct answer by following code :

- (a) 1,2 and 3 (b) 2,3 and 4
- (c) 1,2 and 4 (d) 3 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

25. The word 'Secular' was inserted in the Preamble of the Indian Constitution by

- (a) 25th Amendment (b) 42nd Amendment
(c) 44th Amendment (d) 52nd Amendment

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

26. The goal of Constitution is to secure/assure all its citizens-

1. Justice Social and Economic
2. Liberty of Thought and Expression
3. Equality of Opportunity
4. Dignity of the Individual

Choose the correct answer by using code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1,2 and 3
(c) 2,3 and 4 (d) All above

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

The Preamble embodies the basic philosophy and fundamental values on which the Constitution is based. The Preamble is aimed to secure to all its citizens (1) Justice-Social, Economic, Political (2) Liberty of Thought, Expression, Belief, Faith and Worship (3) Equality of Status and Opportunity (4) Fraternity assuring the Dignity of the Individual and the Unity and Integrity of the Nation.

27. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R) :

Assertion (A) : India is a sovereign socialist secular democratic republic.

Reason (R) : It was substituted by (42nd Amendment) Act 1976 for Sovereign Democratic Republic.

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

The preamble has been amended only once so far, in 1976 by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, which has added three new words - Socialist, Secular & integrity- to the Preamble. This amendment was held to be valid. Hence, option (a) is correct.

28. India has people's sovereignty because the Preamble of the Constitution begins with the words :

- (a) Democratic India (b) Republic of People
(c) Democracy of People (d) We, the People of India

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The Preamble to the Constitution starts with the words- "We the People of India...." These words indicate the Sovereignty of the people or citizens of India. It means that the people of India are not governed by any external power but are directed by the Constitution.

29. Where have the words 'We the people of India' been used in the Constitution of India?

- (a) Directive Principles
(b) Fundamental Rights
(c) Citizenship
(d) Preamble of the Constitution

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

30. "All individuals are fully and equally human" this principle is known as –

- (a) Universalism (b) Holism
(c) Socialism (d) InterActionism

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The principle of 'All individuals are fully and equally human' is known as universalism. According to this principle, every person is entitled to Human Rights without any discrimination.

31. Which among the following is the correct expression of the term 'Secular' in India?

- (a) India has many religions.
(b) Indians have religious freedom.
(c) Following the religion depends upon the will of an individual.
(d) There is no religion of the State in India.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (d)

The Indian Constitution embodies the positive concept of Secularism. Secularism in India means, there is no official religion of the state in India. There is equal treatment of all religions by the state.

32. Which of the following words is NOT mentioned in the Preamble of the Constitution of India?

- (a) Sovereign (b) Democratic
(c) Secular (d) Federal

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The Preamble of the Constitution:

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC and to secure to all its citizens:

JUSTICE, social, economic and political; LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship;

EQUALITY of status and of opportunity;

and to promote among them all FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation;

IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949, do HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION.

The word federal is not mentioned in the preamble. So option (d) is correct.

33. Which of the following words is not in the Preamble to the Constitution of India?

- (a) Socialist (b) Secular
(c) Sovereign (d) Public Welfare

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

The word 'Public Welfare' is not mentioned in the preamble of the Indian Constitution. The other three words SOCIALIST, SECULAR and SOVEREIGN are present in the Preamble.

34. Which one of the following liberty is not embodied in the Preamble of the Constitution of India?

- (a) Liberty of Thought (b) Liberty of Expression
(c) Liberty of Belief (d) Economic Liberty

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

The preamble of the Constitution of India embodies the LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship but does not include economic liberty.

35. Which among the following is not mentioned in the Preamble to the Constitution of India?

- (a) Social Justice (b) Economic Justice
(c) Political Justice (d) Religious Justice

U.P. Lower Sub. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (d)

The Preamble of the Constitution of India mentioned JUSTICE (social, economic and political), whereas the word Religious Justice is not present in the Preamble.

36. Which of the following is true in relation to the Preamble of Constitution of India?

- (a) The words 'Socialist' and 'Secular' were not the part of the Preamble on the enforcement of Constitution in 1950
(b) The above-mentioned words were inserted by amendment in 1977
(c) The above-mentioned words were inserted by amendment in 1985
(d) These two words are not part of the Preamble

M.P.C.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

The words 'Socialist' and 'Secular' were not part of the Preamble of the Constitution at the time of its commencement in 1950. These words were inserted in the preamble by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976. Thus only option (a) is correct.

37. Which part of the Indian Constitution has been described as the 'Soul' of the Constitution?

- (a) Fundamental Rights
(b) Directive Principles of State Policy
(c) The Preamble
(d) Right to Constitutional Remedies

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006, U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

U.P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2008, Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

U.P. P.S.C. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

The Preamble of the Constitution is called the 'Soul of the Constitution.' K.M. Munshi, a member of the drafting committee, defined the Preamble as the "Horoscope of our sovereign democratic Republic." Subhash Kashyap has

mentioned that “If Constitution is the body then Preamble is the Soul, If the Preamble is a foundation then Constitution is a structure or building standing on it.

Note: It is notable that Dr. B.R. Ambedkar has recognized ‘The Right to Constitutional Remedies (Article 32) as the heart and soul of the Constitution, so if the question is asked with respect to Dr. Ambedkar then in such case, option (d) will be the correct answer.

38. Who among the following called the Preamble of Indian Constitution “the horoscope of our sovereign, democratic republic”?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru (b) Vallabhbhai Patel
- (c) B.R. Ambedkar (d) K.M. Munshi
- (e) Mahatma Gandhi

Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

39. Who has termed Constitution a sacred document?

- (a) B. R. Ambedkar (b) Mahatma Gandhi
- (c) Deendayal Upadhyay (d) Mohammad Ali Jinnah

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Bhimrao Ambedkar in 1947, became the Chairman of the Drafting Committee of the Constituent Assembly of India. Ambedkar was a staunch Constitutionalist. He believed that a government must be Constitutional and that the Constitution must be treated as a basic and sacred document.

40. In which case did the Supreme Court first declare that the Preamble is not a part of the Constitution?

- (a) Berubari (b) Sajjan Singh
- (c) Golak Nath (d) Keshvanand Bharti

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

In the Berubari case (1960), the Supreme Court of India declared that the Preamble is not an integral part of the Indian Constitution.

41. In which of the following cases Supreme Court held that ‘The Preamble forms part of the Constitution’?

- (a) Union of India Vs. Dr. Kohli
- (b) Banarsidas Vs. State of U.P.
- (c) Bommai Vs. Union of India
- (d) Malak Singh Vs. State of Punjab

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

In the case of S.R. Bommai Vs. Union of India, 1994, the Supreme Court held that the Preamble is an integral part of the Constitution. In the case of Kesavanand Bharti Vs the State of Kerala (1973), a bench of 13 Judges of the Supreme Court outlined the Basic Structure doctrine of the Constitution.

42. In which of the following cases the Supreme Court regarded Preamble as a part of the basic structure of India Constitution?

- (a) Beru Bari Case (b) A.K. Gopalan Case
- (c) Privy Purse Case (d) Keshwanand Bharti Case

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (d)

The Preamble was regarded as a part of the basic structure of the Indian constitution by the Supreme Court in the Keshavanand Bharti case.

43. The ideals and objectives outlined in the Preamble of the Indian Constitution have been further elaborated in –

- (a) The Chapter on Fundamental Rights
- (b) The Chapter on Directive Principles of State Policy
- (c) The Chapter on Directive Principles of State Policy, Fundamental Rights, and Fundamental Duties
- (d) Nowhere else in the text of the Constitution.

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

The main objective of the Constitution is to secure justice-social, economic and political, liberty of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship, equality of status and opportunity, to all its citizens. The advancement of the people should not be a barrier to the advancement of the nation, so the promotion of fraternity is also aimed in the Constitution. The ideals and objectives outlined by the Preamble are included in the chapters related to Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles and Fundamental Duties.

44. The objective of Indian Constitution is reflected in which of the following?

- (a) Fundamental Rights
- (b) Preamble of the Constitution
- (c) Directive Principles of State Policy
- (d) Parliament

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.